

L.A. Care
HEALTH PLAN®

For All of L.A.

July 17, 2026

NICOLAS HERNANDEZ

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] CA, 9 [REDACTED]

Member Name: NICOLAS [REDACTED] HERNANDEZ

Member ID: [REDACTED]

Reference Number: [REDACTED]03

Line of Business: Medi-Cal

Date of Service: July 14, 2026

Regarding: Quality of care



Dear NICOLAS HERNANDEZ,

Thank you for bringing your concern(s) to our attention. L.A. Care Health Plan received your grievance on July 14, 2026. The following describes the results of our review:

Concern/s:

Your grievance stated that you were experiencing difficulties accessing behavioral health services and maintaining continuity of care during a medically supervised benzodiazepine taper. You reported that you were without a prescribing provider, had a limited supply of medication remaining, and believed that your treatment was interrupted because your previous behavioral health provider was not being paid.

Resolution:

We completed a thorough review of your concerns, including information provided by you and information obtained from Carelon Behavioral Health, our behavioral health administrator.

- Carelon Behavioral Health did not identify call records or claims related to your concern dated July 14, 2026.
- On July 15, 2026, Carelon submitted an urgent request for its Clinical Team to conduct a risk assessment.
- Carelon's Clinical Team attempted to contact you by telephone on three separate occasions at the phone number on file (([REDACTED]) [REDACTED]). They were unable to leave voicemail messages because your voicemail mailbox was full.
- Carelon also identified in-network behavioral health prescribing providers with appointment availability, including:
 - o Brain Health (Telehealth) – Earliest available appointments on July 21, 2026

1200

~~1055~~ W. 7th Street, ~~10th floor~~, Los Angeles, CA 90017

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SINCE 1997

1619 - 12PM

- o Inland Psych Medical Group, Inc. – In-person appointments available within 15 business days
- o Healing Journeys Mental Health – Earliest available appointment on July 28, 2026

We also attempted to contact you on July 16, 2026 (11:27 a.m. and 12:14 p.m.) and July 17, 2026 (10:46 a.m.). Our calls were not answered, and we were unable to leave a voicemail because your mailbox was full.

Based on the information available during our review, we could not substantiate that L.A. Care or Carelon Behavioral Health caused an interruption in your care due to nonpayment of your previous provider. Our investigation did not identify evidence supporting that allegation.

However, we recognize the importance of uninterrupted behavioral health treatment, particularly during medication management. Carelon identified available in-network providers who are accepting appointments, and outreach was initiated to assist you with connecting to care and completing a clinical risk assessment.

If you still need assistance obtaining an appointment with a behavioral health prescribing provider or continue to have concerns about your medication or treatment, please contact L.A. Care Member Services as soon as possible so we can assist you.

After careful review, your case has also been forwarded to our Quality Improvement Department to determine whether appropriate medical standards of care were provided. The Quality Improvement Department will investigate and review all relevant information and will take any necessary corrective actions to support ongoing quality improvement.

Please note that, due to federal and state confidentiality laws—including California Evidence Code Section 1157, Health and Safety Code Section 1370, and California Business and Professions Code Section 805—as well as medical peer review requirements, we are unable to share details of the investigation or the outcome of any peer review activities. We want to assure you that all quality-of-care concerns are carefully tracked, monitored, and addressed as part of our comprehensive Quality Improvement Program.

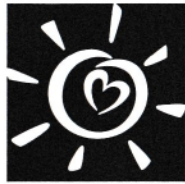
Thank you for taking the time to share your experience. Your feedback helps us improve the care and services we provide to our members.

We hope that you are satisfied with this review. If you are not satisfied with the results, you may file an appeal to the Department of Managed Health Care.

California Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) Office of the Ombudsman

You may also call the Ombudsman Office of the California Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) for help. The Ombudsman Office helps Medi-Cal beneficiaries to fully use their rights and responsibilities as a member of a managed care plan. To find out more, call toll-free 1-888-452-8609.

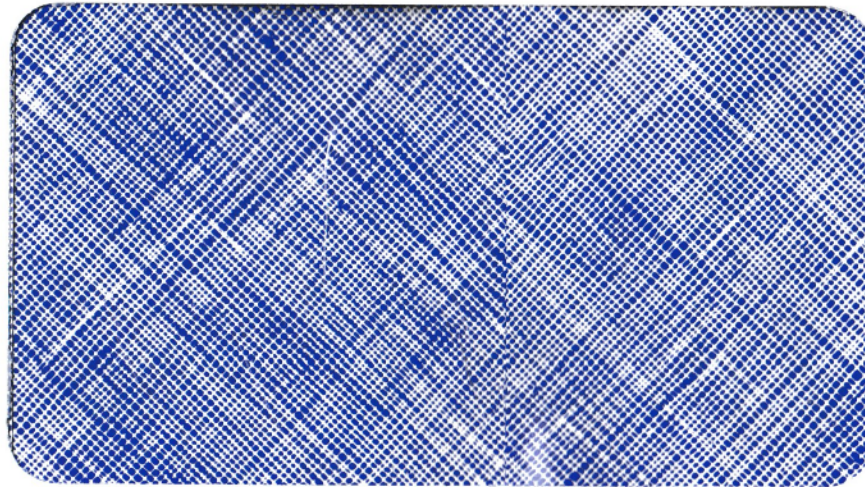
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